

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 6 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ K 7 5 3

♠ A 4

♥ A Q J 10 7 6

♦ A 5 2

♣ A 9



♠ K 9 7 3

♥ 8 3 2

♦ J 4

♣ Q J 10 4

♠ Q J 5

♥ K 5 4

♦ 10 9 7 3

♣ 8 6 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣Q

Well, you are **SUPPOSED** to have plenty of points for game. So why isn't it laydown? Answer: Because South has ♠ Q J instead of ♠ K. If he had ♠ K it would be a laydown.

So all you have to do is turn the ♠ Q J into the equivalent of the ♠ K. It's easy.

Win the ♣A. Take two rounds of trumps with the ♥ A Q. West shows out on the second trump lead. Play the ♠ A, then the ♠ 4. East will win the ♠ K and the defense will take their ♣ trick. Then they must give you the lead and you play a ♥ to dummy's ♥ K, pulling East's final trump. Play the good ♠ Q, discarding one of your ♦ losers.

Admittedly it would have been simpler if South held the ♠ K.

With the ♠ Q J instead you just have to take care with entries. (Make that entry, singular.)

You are very close to the 22 points needed to open 2 ♣.

Of course close only counts in horse-shoes and hand grenades. So you open 1 ♥.

Partner responds 2 ♥.

This is a no-brainer. With partner showing 6-10 points you have plenty enough for game.

So you bid 4 ♥.

North plays 4 ♥. East leads the ♣Q.

North plays 4 ♥. East leads the ♣Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
♥ K 10 4
♦ J 9 4 2
♣ J 10 9 3 2

♠ K Q J 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ K 7

♣ A 8 7 4



♠ 8 6 4

♥ A J 9 2

♦ Q 10 3

♣ K 6 5

♠ A 10 9 7 3

♥ Q 7 6

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ Q

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♣J

ruff both ♦ losers in dummy. Or, you could ruff three ♣ losers in your hand, it would work out the same.

The first key is to go up with the ♣A. you cannot afford to lose a ♣ now with those three ♥ losers staring you in the face.

Next play the ♠K and ♠A, but West shows out on the second one. Don't pull a third one. You need to make those last five trumps separately. Take your two high ♦s, then start cross-ruffing ♣s and ♦s. You will lose the final three ♥s.

This is really a cross-ruff type plan.

And with any cross-ruff it is best to pull as many trumps as you can spare before you start ruffing. Leave yourself just the number of trumps you need.

You have a real bare-bones 13 points. No matter, you don't pass with 13. So you open 1 ♠.

Partner responds 2 ♣.

You have two choices - bid 2NT or bid 2 ♦. Neither is showing any extra strength so partner shouldn't go crazy. Not liking that singleton you say 2 ♦.

Partner goes crazy and bids 4 ♠.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♣J.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♣J.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 5

You may think you're lucky they didn't take their ♥ tricks, but the truth is that they will probably get them anyway. If trumps split 2-2 then you can easily

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 5 2
♥ Q 7
♦ J 10 5 2
♣ A K 9 4

♠ A K 9 8 6 4

♥ 8 6 3

♦ A 7

♣ 7 3



♠ 10 3
♥ K 10 5 2
♦ Q 9 6
♣ J 10 8 2

♠ Q J

♥ A J 9 4

♦ K 8 4 3

♣ Q 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♣J

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

Two choices come to mind - 2NT or 2♥.

Of the two, 2♥ is better because it prevents a possible 4-4 ♥ fit from being lost. Partner rebids his ♠s.

Two opening hands equal one game. Since partner has 6 ♠ that game might as well be 4 ♠.

South would play 4 ♠.

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North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♣J. They play two more high ♣s.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♣J. They play two more high ♣s.

You ruff the third ♣, then play ♠Q and ♠J. Come to your hand with the ♦A and pull the last trump. Now decide what to do with the ♥s.

If East has both ♥K and ♥Q then a simple finesse of the ♥J will bring in the contract. This is only a 25% chance.

If the high ♥ honors are split, but East holds the ♥10 then a finesse of the ♥9 will force West to win with his high honor. You can return to your hand and then finesse East out of his other ♥ honor. This play has about a 50% chance of working so it is the one you should make.

This is called a Deep Finesse.

The only time it is a mistake is when East holds the ♥ K Q and West holds the ♥10. Even in that case though some Wests will "split their honors" and give it away.

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 8 5
 ♥ A 5 3 2
 ♦ J 7
 ♣ J 9 6 5

♠ A K
 ♥ 10 9 8
 ♦ 8 6 5
 ♣ A Q 10 8 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 7 3
 ♥ K J 7 4
 ♦ Q 10 9 3
 ♣ 4

♠ J 6 4 2
 ♥ Q 6
 ♦ A K 4 2
 ♣ K 7 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

Lead: ♦ 10

With 14 points and only one biddable suit this was a snap. You open 1♣. Partner responds with 1♠.

This one isn't such a snap. You sure cannot support ♠s with only 2 of them, even good ones. You aren't supposed to rebid your ♣s without a 6-card suit. You hate to bid Notrump with neither of the two red suits stopped, and you cannot pass. So you bite the bullet and say 1NT. Partner jumps it to 3NT and you pass, hoping he can stop the red suits.

North plays 3NT. It turns out partner can't stop ♥s either and the defenders reel off 4 ♥ tricks, then lead a small ♦.

North plays 3NT. The defenders win 4 ♥ tricks, then play a small ♦.

Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 3 : Total = 7

You need 2 more tricks and you expect to get them from ♣s. This should have been evident while they were leading all those ♥ winners so you would not have discarded one of the ♣s from your hand. But you also had to be careful not to discard even one of dummy's ♣s, you need all three of them.

If the ♣s split 3-2 it wouldn't matter, but if West happens to have ♣ J x x then you will need dummy's third ♣ to make a finesse. You first play your ♣A, then lead a small ♣ to dummy's ♣K. East shows out on this ♣ so you know that West has ♣ J 9 left. You lead dummy's ♣7, finessing West out of the ♣J.

Suppose you had incorrectly discarded dummy's ♣3 on one of those ♥s. You would have played the ♣s by first leading small to the ♣K (East following) then the ♣7 back toward your hand. It is true that you **COULD** finesse now but you wouldn't know that you **SHOULD** since you wouldn't know that East was now void.

This was a very difficult hand.